

BEAMING IN BOSTON
Michelle Kwan takes a big lead at the U.S. Figure Skating Championships after receiving 7 6.0s in the short program. **D7**



NFL
Palmer likes opportunities waiting in Cincinnati
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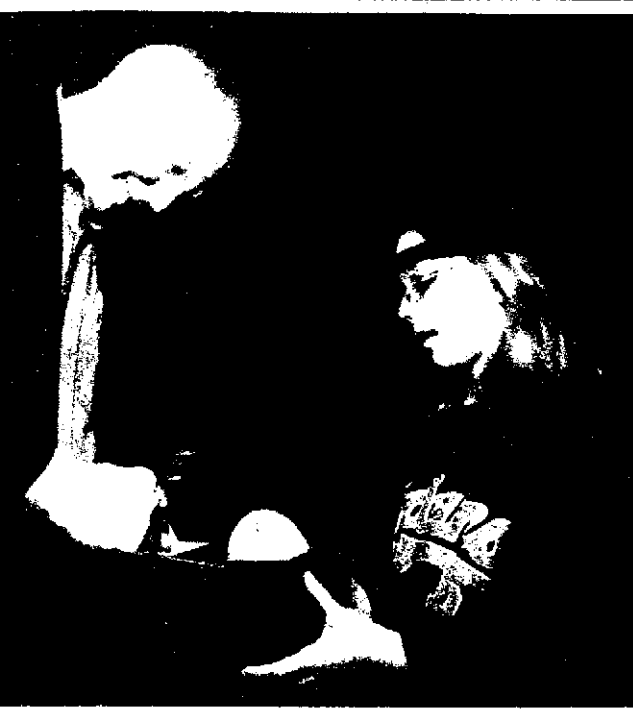
HIGH SCHOOL BASKETBALL
Elyria Catholic uses big run to fell 1st-place Lake Catholic
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DOUG CLARKE
After much too much delay, OSU made right choice
Page D6

Sports

The Chronicle-Telegram Saturday, January 20, 2001 **D1**

TRIBE'S PRESS TOUR CARAVAN



CHUCK HUMEL / CHRONICLE

A PAIR OF INDIANS FANS: Tribe manager Charlie Manuel signs an autograph for Cassandra Howell, 9, of Elyria Friday at DeLuca's Place in the Park.

Tribe's proof is in the winning

Indians have a simple goal: Regain control of the Central

Chris Assenheimer
The Chronicle-Telegram

CLEVELAND — For the first time in a while, the Indians have something to prove.

Despite winning 90 games and enjoying one of its finest late-season finishes in recent memory, the Tribe missed out on the playoffs for the first time since 1994, losing its stranglehold on the Central Division in the process.

All of it has added some extra incentive for the Indians as they prepare to head to Winter Haven, Fla., for spring training next month.

"We fought through some injuries and played well at the end of the season, but it wasn't enough," said Indians manager Charlie Manuel, who was on hand Friday at DeLuca's Place in the Park for the final leg of the Tribe's Press Tour Caravan. "We learned last year that winning 90 games doesn't get you very much."

What it got the Indians was a pat on the back for perseverance and a wake-up call that their Central Division dominance had come to an end.

"We should be hungrier," said first baseman Jim Thome. "It was a long winter, but maybe it was a good thing. We should be coming back this year with some extra incentive. Obviously, the key is to keep everyone healthy."

That wasn't the case early last season when the Indians

RUSSELL BRANYAN and Jacob Cruz are trying to find a spot in the Tribe lineup. Complete Press Tour Caravan coverage. **D4.**

See **TRIBE**, D4

Shoreman shocker



STEVE MANHEIM / CHRONICLE

RIISING ABOVE IT ALL: Avon Lake's Rob Curry shoots over Olmsted Falls' Zach Mucha Friday during the Shoremen's 72-70 win at Olmsted Falls. The victory gave Avon Lake sole possession of first place in the Southwestern Conference.

Avon Lake beats Falls at buzzer

Roger Negin
The Chronicle-Telegram

OLMSTED FALLS — Dave Olinger was as stunned as anyone by the ending.

"I don't know how we won," said the Avon Lake basketball coach. "I don't know if we deserved it, but it's over now and we're going to take it. We came out with a win."

It was a thrilling win, an important win.

When Brian Ingleright scored with two seconds left on a break-away layup, it gave the Shoremen a 72-70 victory over rival Olmsted Falls and first place in the Southwestern Conference.

Avon Lake (11-1, 7-0) has one day to celebrate. The Shoremen have another crucial matchup tonight against visiting North Olmsted. Olmsted Falls (6-4, 6-1) has a game against Bay.

Ingleright, Avon Lake's leading scorer who was held in check most of the night, came up with two big plays in the final 38 seconds to cap a tremendous comeback. The Shoremen trailed 61-51 eight seconds into the fourth quarter.

"It was such a struggle," Olinger said. "We'd cut it to four and then it was back to eight or 10. We couldn't get it under four."

Not until the final minute.

Olmsted Falls led 70-66 with 1:33 left. Ingleright, who'd scored only six points at that time, had his shot blocked by Mike Gansey, but rebounded and scored with 1:11 on the clock to cut the margin to two.

But Ingleright wasn't finished.

Olmsted Falls took a timeout with 44 seconds left in the game, but six seconds after play resumed Ingleright scored again. He poked the ball out from under Zach Mucha's hand to Corey Jones. Jones fed Ingleright for the

See **SHOREMAN**, D2

Brutal trip ends with tough loss

John Mossman
The Associated Press

DENVER — Nick Van Exel missed the Denver Nuggets' shootaround Friday morning because of a splitting headache. Twelve hours later, it was the Cleveland Cavaliers who needed a pain reliever.

Van Exel, who finished with 19 points and 10 assists, had 11 points in the fourth quarter as the Nuggets twice rallied from five-point deficits to beat the Cavaliers 91-88. The Cavs finished a West Coast trip 1-5.

Antonio McDyess had 20 points — eight of them in the final quarter — and 16 rebounds as the siz-

zling Nuggets won for the ninth time in 10 games.

Raef LaFrentz added 15 points and George McCLOUD had 14, including two free throws that put the Nuggets ahead for good with 1:45 remaining.

"Nick woke up with a terrible headache," Nuggets coach Dan Issel said. "He came in and we gave him some medication and sent him home."

"Tonight, he kept telling me he was fine, but he didn't look like he was fine. Still, he got two big 3-pointers and hit the two free throws that sewed up the game for us."

See **CAVS**, D7



CAVS

NEXT UP

WHO: Cleveland vs. Portland

WHEN: Monday, 7:30 p.m.

WHERE: Gund Arena

TV/RADIO: Fox Sports Net; WEOL 930-AM; WTAM 1100-AM





AP

SPARED THE DEATH PENALTY: Rae Carruth is found innocent of first-degree murder but guilty of three other charges.

Carruth acquitted of murder charge

Jury finds ex-receiver guilty on 3 counts

Paul Nowell
The Associated Press

CHARLOTTE, N.C. — Former NFL player Rae Carruth was acquitted of first-degree murder but convicted of conspiracy and two other charges Friday in the fatal shooting of his pregnant girlfriend.

Carruth was spared the death penalty but could get as much as 20 years in prison for conspiracy to commit murder.

Cherica Adams, 24, was ambushed and shot four times in her car on a Charlotte street in November 1999 in an attack pros-

ecutors said Carruth arranged to avoid paying child support. She died a month later.

The 26-year-old former Carolina Panthers receiver was grimaced as the jury's decision, reached after about 20 hours of deliberation, was announced. A day earlier, the jurors had said they were deadlocked.

He also was found guilty of shooting into an occupied vehicle and using an instrument — a gun — with intent to kill an unborn child.

Juror Edward Karst said he

See **CARRUTH**, D9

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